



Customer Reply Activity

Testing, Acceptance, and Go-Live Guide

A repeatable plan for proving routing, assignment, filtering, and notifications.

This guide provides a complete validation plan for Customer Reply Activity. It can be used during first installation, configuration changes, mail-server changes, upgrades, or rollout to a new business model. The tests are written as business scenarios so administrators and key users can execute them without reading the module code.

DOCUMENT

Testing and Go-Live Guide

MODULE

mail_customer_reply_activity

FORMAT

A4 documentation set

SUPPORT

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DOCUMENT MAP

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SECTION Purpose of the Test Plan

The module joins several parts of Odoo: outgoing email, incoming mail routing, chatter, model configuration, user assignment, activities, deadlines, automatic-message filtering, and notifications. A complete acceptance test must prove the full chain, not only the existence of a rule form.

The main acceptance statement is:

ACCEPTANCE STATEMENT An eligible external reply is preserved in the correct record chatter and becomes an assigned, deadline-driven Customer Reply activity. Ineligible traffic remains outside the activity workflow without damaging standard mail history.

This guide validates both sides of that statement.

Test roles

Prepare these roles before testing:

- **System Administrator:** installs the module, creates rules, checks technical email records, and reviews logs.
- **Primary Responsible User:** receives activities from the configured record field.
- **Fallback Responsible User:** receives activities when primary ownership is missing.
- **External Test Contact:** replies from a mailbox that is not linked to an internal Odoo user.
- **Internal Test User:** sends an employee reply to confirm internal filtering.

One person may perform several roles, but the email addresses and Odoo user types must remain clearly separated.

SECTION Test Preparation

Required mail flow

Confirm standard routing before module-specific tests:

1. Create a business record with chatter and activities.
2. Send an email from that record to the external test mailbox.
3. Use the mailbox's normal Reply action.
4. Process incoming mail.
5. Confirm that the answer appears on the original record.

Do not continue to activity diagnosis when the message is missing from chatter. Correct the standard incoming mail route first.

Recommended test data

Use clear records that are not part of real customer work.

Test item	Recommended value
Main record	Customer Reply Acceptance - Main Flow
No-merge record	Customer Reply Acceptance - Separate Activities
Fallback record	Customer Reply Acceptance - Fallback
No-owner record	Customer Reply Acceptance - No Responsible
Exclusion record	Customer Reply Acceptance - Excluded Sender

Test item	Recommended value
Notification record	Customer Reply Acceptance - Notification
Primary user	Reply Test Owner
Fallback user	Reply Test Manager
External address	A dedicated mailbox not used by an internal user
Internal address	The email of an active internal user

Use a unique email subject and unique Message-Id for every new reply. Reply within the original thread so In-Reply-To and References are preserved.

Baseline rule

Create one active rule for the chosen model with:

- Responsible Field set to the primary ownership field;
- Fallback Responsible set to Reply Test Manager;
- Activity Type set to Customer Reply;
- Reaction Time set to a short visible period;
- Merge Replies enabled;
- Ignore Automatic Messages enabled;
- default exclusions present.

Record the rule values before starting. Change only the setting required by each scenario, then return to the baseline.

Evidence to record

For every test, capture:

- test record name;
- sender and subject;
- time the reply was processed;
- whether the reply appears in chatter;
- number of active and completed Customer Reply activities;
- assigned user;
- deadline;
- reply counter;
- latest sender and subject in the activity note;
- number and state of outgoing notification records when relevant;
- pass or fail result and short observation.

Do not include mailbox passwords, private tokens, or unrelated customer content in test evidence.

SECTION Installation and Configuration Tests

Scenario 1 - Installation and upgrade completeness

Objective: confirm that all module components load through the normal registry process.

Procedure: install or upgrade Customer Reply Activity. Open the Apps record, Customer Reply Activities menu, rule list and form, Settings entry, Activity Types, and Russian interface when that language is enabled.

Expected result: the rule model, activity extension, generic Customer Reply type, access rights, views, menus, translations, and module description are available. No manual database action is required.

Scenario 2 - Rule menu and views

Objective: confirm that administrators can manage the full rule configuration.

Procedure: open Customer Reply Activities from General Settings and from Technical Email. Open list, form, and search views. Archive one temporary rule and use the Archived filter.

Expected result: both menu paths open the same configuration. Model, Responsible Field, Fallback Responsible, Activity Type, Reaction Time, Reaction Unit, Merge Replies, Ignore Automatic Messages, and Sender Exclusions are available. Archived rules can be found.

Scenario 3 - Field and activity-type restrictions

Objective: confirm that rule choices are compatible with the selected model.

Procedure: select the target model. Open the Responsible Field dropdown and Activity Type dropdown. Change the model and observe dependent fields. Attempt to use an incompatible value through a controlled administration method if part of the test policy.

Expected result: responsible choices are limited to Many2one or Many2many user relations on the selected model. Activity types are limited to active generic types or active types for the model. Server validation rejects incompatible values.

Scenario 4 - One active rule per model

Objective: confirm that competing active configurations cannot exist.

Procedure: keep the baseline rule active and try to create another active rule for the same model. Then archive the first rule and activate the second.

Expected result: two active rules for the same model are rejected. After the first rule is archived, the replacement can become active.

Scenario 5 - Reaction time validation

Objective: confirm that invalid negative deadlines are blocked.

Procedure: try to save a negative Reaction Time. Then save zero and a positive amount in each supported unit.

Expected result: a negative value is rejected. Zero, days, weeks, and months are accepted.

SECTION Core Reply and Activity Tests

Scenario 6 - Complete external reply flow

Objective: prove the complete outgoing and incoming conversation path.

Procedure: create the main test record with a primary owner. Send an email from chatter, reply from the external mailbox, process incoming mail, and reopen the record.

Expected result: Odoo connects the response to the original conversation and stores it in the correct record chatter.

Scenario 7 - First activity creation

Objective: confirm that one eligible reply creates one actionable activity.

Procedure: continue from Scenario 6 and inspect the record activities.

Expected result: exactly one active Customer Reply activity exists with summary **Customer replied - response required**. It is assigned to the primary owner. The note contains sender, subject, received time, and reply count 1. The deadline matches the rule.

Scenario 8 - Merge a second reply

Objective: confirm that merge mode keeps one open responsibility.

Procedure: record the first activity deadline. Send a second external reply in the same conversation while the activity remains open.

Expected result: one active activity remains. The reply count becomes 2, the latest message and note refer to the second reply, and the original deadline does not change.

Scenario 9 - Reply after completion

Objective: confirm that completed work is not reopened.

Procedure: complete the merged activity, then send another external reply in the thread.

Expected result: the completed activity remains in history. A new active activity is created with count 1 and a newly calculated deadline.

Scenario 10 - Merge disabled

Objective: confirm separate responsibility for each reply.

Procedure: disable Merge Replies. Use the no-merge record and process two external replies.

Expected result: two separate active Customer Reply activities exist. Each has count 1 and its own deadline.

Scenario 11 - Many2many assignment

Objective: confirm assignment to several eligible users.

Procedure: use a model with a Many2many user field, assign two active internal users, configure that field, and process one external reply.

Expected result: one activity is created for each eligible user. Portal, public, or inactive accounts in the field do not receive activities.

SECTION Fallback and Missing Ownership Tests

Scenario 12 - Fallback responsible

Objective: confirm controlled assignment when primary ownership is empty.

Procedure: clear the Responsible Field on the fallback test record while keeping the fallback in the rule. Process an external reply.

Expected result: one activity is assigned to Reply Test Manager. The fallback is used because no eligible primary user exists.

Scenario 13 - Primary owner takes priority

Objective: confirm that fallback is not an extra recipient.

Procedure: restore an active primary owner and process a new external reply on a clean record.

Expected result: the primary owner receives the activity. The fallback does not receive a second activity.

Scenario 14 - No primary and no fallback

Objective: confirm predictable behavior without an eligible owner.

Procedure: clear the record owner and clear the Fallback Responsible. Process an external reply.

Expected result: the reply remains in chatter, no Customer Reply activity is created, and no unrelated administrator is assigned. The missing responsible condition is available in the server log.

Scenario 15 - Ownership changes during an open activity

Objective: confirm user-specific merge behavior.

Procedure: create an activity for the first owner, change the record owner, and process another external reply while the first activity remains open.

Expected result: the first activity remains assigned to the first owner. A new activity is created for the current owner because the responsible user is part of the merge key.

SECTION Sender Exclusion Tests

Scenario 16 - Exact sender exclusion

Objective: block one known automated sender without blocking other addresses.

Procedure: add `exact@example.com` to Sender Exclusions. Process a reply from that address and another from `customer@example.com`.

Expected result: both messages can remain in chatter, but only the allowed customer address creates an activity.

Scenario 17 - Domain and wildcard patterns

Objective: validate all supported exclusion forms.

Procedure: test an `@blocked.example` pattern, a domain-only pattern, `*.notifications.example`, and `no-reply@*`. Also test `customer@allowed.example`.

Expected result: matching exact, domain, subdomain, and mailbox patterns are excluded. The unrelated allowed address remains eligible.

Scenario 18 - Broad-pattern safety check

Objective: prevent accidental suppression of real customers.

Procedure: review every configured wildcard. For each domain-level rule, send or simulate one known allowed human sender from the closest relevant domain.

Expected result: only intended addresses are excluded. No global or overly broad pattern blocks the normal customer path.

SECTION Automatic and Internal Message Tests

Scenario 19 - Normal message and explicit non-automatic value

Objective: confirm that human replies are not over-filtered.

Procedure: test a normal email without automatic headers and a message with `Auto-Submitted: no`.

Expected result: both messages remain eligible and create or merge the expected activity.

Scenario 20 - Confirmed automatic reply

Objective: confirm positive automatic-message detection.

Procedure: process a message with `Auto-Submitted: auto-replied` while Ignore Automatic Messages is enabled.

Expected result: standard mail routing can keep the message in chatter, but no Customer Reply activity is created.

Scenario 21 - Bulk and mailing-list indicators

Objective: confirm that list traffic does not create follow-up work.

Procedure: test `Precedence: bulk` and `List-Id` separately.

Expected result: each message is recognized as automatic or list traffic and does not create an activity while filtering is enabled.

Scenario 22 - Delivery and loop indicators

Objective: validate additional machine-message signals.

Procedure: use safe test messages for an empty `Return-Path`, `multipart/report`, and a recognized loop or autoresponder header.

Expected result: each recognized machine message remains outside the Customer Reply activity workflow.

Scenario 23 - Ambiguous suppression header

Objective: confirm that a real reply is not hidden only because it asks receiving systems to suppress automatic responses.

Procedure: process a normal human-style reply that includes `X-Auto-Response-Suppress: All` and no confirmed automatic indicator.

Expected result: the header alone does not classify the message as automatic. The reply remains eligible.

Scenario 24 - Internal author

Objective: confirm employee filtering through the chatter author.

Procedure: process a reply whose message author is linked to an internal user.

Expected result: no Customer Reply activity is created.

Scenario 25 - Internal email address

Objective: confirm employee filtering when author mapping is incomplete.

Procedure: send from the normalized email of an active or inactive internal user without relying only on the author link.

Expected result: the sender is treated as internal and does not create an activity. An unrelated external address remains eligible.

SECTION Notification Tests

Scenario 26 - Initial notification count

Objective: prove that the first activity does not produce duplicate notification emails.

Procedure: use a clean notification record. Process one external reply and inspect the assigned activity and **Technical > Email > Emails**.

Expected result: one activity with count 1 exists and exactly one corresponding activity notification is prepared through the standard creation path.

Scenario 27 - Merged reply notification count

Objective: prove that each later reply gives one fresh reminder.

Procedure: with merge enabled, process two replies for a clean record. Inspect the activity and outgoing email records.

Expected result: one activity remains with count 2. There are two notification events in total: one for activity creation and one for the merged update.

Scenario 28 - Activity without delivered email

Objective: separate activity correctness from email-channel delivery.

Procedure: use a user preference or mail setup where no external notification email is expected, then process an eligible reply.

Expected result: the activity is still created and visible in Odoo. The absence of a delivered email follows standard notification configuration and does not mean the activity workflow failed.

SECTION Routing and Reliability Tests

Scenario 29 - Exact parent route

Objective: confirm that reply headers return the message to the exact original record.

Procedure: create two similar test records. Send from the first record and reply with **In-Reply-To** and **References** connected to its parent message.

Expected result: the incoming message and activity appear on the first record only.

Scenario 30 - New alias email is not a reply activity

Objective: confirm the boundary between a new inbound email and a reply.

Procedure: send a new message to an alias without valid reply headers to an earlier record message.

Expected result: standard alias behavior continues, but Customer Reply Activity does not classify it as a response to an existing conversation.

Scenario 31 - Repeated Message-Id

Objective: confirm duplicate protection.

Procedure: submit the same eligible raw message twice with the same Message-Id.

Expected result: the repeated copy does not create or merge another activity.

Scenario 32 - Concurrent merged replies

Objective: confirm stable merging when different replies are processed close together.

Procedure: process two different eligible replies for the same rule, record, and user with merge enabled through the normal worker setup.

Expected result: one active activity remains with the correct reply count. No duplicate open activity is created for the same merge key.

Scenario 33 - Activity-specific failure isolation

Objective: confirm that the standard communication record is protected.

Procedure: in a controlled test environment, create a configuration condition that prevents activity scheduling, such as removing all eligible owners.

Expected result: the reply remains in chatter even though no activity is created. The condition is logged for administration.

SECTION Consolidated Acceptance Matrix

Area	Minimum passing evidence	Critical result
Installation	Menus, views, rule model, activity type, access, and translations load.	Module is operational without manual database changes.
Routing	External reply appears on the exact original record.	Standard chatter history is preserved.
First activity	One open activity, correct owner, note, count, and deadline.	Reply becomes actionable.
Merge	One open activity, increased count, latest context, unchanged first deadline.	Repeated replies stay visible without clutter.
Completion	New reply after completion creates a new activity.	Completed work is not rewritten.
Separate mode	Two replies create two activities.	Rule honors independent work items.
Fallback	Empty primary ownership uses the configured fallback only.	Unassigned records remain controlled.
No owner	Chatter remains, no arbitrary assignment.	Behavior is safe and predictable.
Exclusions	Matching sender creates no activity; allowed sender still does.	Noise is reduced without hiding customers.
Automatic filtering	Confirmed machine traffic is ignored; normal traffic remains eligible.	Filter is selective.
Internal filtering	Employee sender creates no customer activity.	Internal discussion does not become external follow-up.
Notifications	One notification for creation and one per merge.	No duplicate first notification and no silent merged reply.
Reliability	Duplicate Message-Id and concurrent merge paths remain controlled.	Activity counts and open items stay consistent.

SECTION Automated Test Suite Reference

The post-install TransactionCase suite covers nine focused scenarios:

- `test_activity_type_is_available`

- `test_automatic_and_internal_replies_are_ignored`
- `test_automatic_message_headers`
- `test_completed_activity_is_not_merged`
- `test_excluded_address_patterns`
- `test_external_reply_creates_and_merges_activity`
- `test_fallback_responsible`
- `test_internal_sender_detection`
- `test_merge_can_be_disabled`

The full suite was executed twice after the final notification and mail-classification changes. Both executions completed all nine scenarios successfully across 1,118 database queries.

Automated tests protect core rules, but they do not replace end-to-end validation with the actual mail server, user preferences, business model, and external mailbox used by the company.

SECTION Go-Live Plan

Pilot phase

Start with one model and a small responsible team.

1. Approve the assignment field and fallback user.
2. Approve the reaction time and merge policy.
3. Review default and company-specific exclusions.
4. Execute the required acceptance scenarios.
5. Explain the daily user workflow to the pilot team.
6. Monitor activities, chatter, notifications, and logs for several business days.

Wider rollout

For each additional model:

1. Identify the true operational owner field.
2. Select a fallback who manages that process.
3. Decide whether repeated replies are one responsibility or separate work items.
4. Confirm the model-level scope, including all document types that share the model.
5. Create the rule.
6. Run first reply, merge, completion, fallback, exclusion, internal, automatic, and notification tests.
7. Communicate the new activity process to users before activation.

Monitoring during the first business cycle

- Review open Customer Reply activities daily.
- Compare several activities with their source chatter messages.
- Ask responsible users whether notification delivery matches expectations.
- Review warnings for missing responsible users.
- Add only narrow exclusions for confirmed unwanted senders.
- Review any real reply that stayed in chatter without an activity.
- Confirm that deadlines match the intended calendar policy.

SECTION Regression Plan After Changes

Repeat a focused regression whenever one of these areas changes:

- incoming mail server or fetch method;
- alias, catchall, or domain configuration;
- selected model or responsible field;
- fallback user;
- activity type;
- merge setting;
- automatic-message setting;
- sender exclusion patterns;
- user type, active state, email, or notification preference;
- module code or dependent mail components.

Minimum regression set:

1. One normal external reply.
2. One merged second reply.
3. One reply after completion.
4. One fallback case.
5. One excluded sender and one allowed sender.
6. One confirmed automatic message and one normal message.
7. One internal sender.
8. Initial and merged notification count.

SECTION Sign-Off Checklist

- Standard incoming reply reaches the correct chatter.
- Eligible reply creates the correct activity.
- Primary and fallback assignment are approved by the business owner.
- Missing ownership does not cause arbitrary assignment.
- Reaction deadline is understood as calendar time.
- Merge behavior matches the team's operating process.
- Completed activity behavior is accepted.
- Sender exclusions are narrow and verified with allowed addresses.
- Automatic-message filtering accepts human replies and rejects confirmed machine traffic.
- Internal sender filtering works.
- Initial and merged notification counts are correct.
- Duplicate message handling is confirmed.
- Administrators know where to review rules, outgoing emails, and logs.
- Users know how to read, respond to, and complete the activity.
- Support ownership and the first review date are agreed.

SECTION Validation Summary

The validated implementation covers installation, administration views, model and field restrictions, complete incoming reply routing, chatter storage, first activity creation, reply merging, completed activity separation, disabled merge behavior, primary and fallback assignment, missing ownership, sender exclusions, automatic-message classification, internal-user filtering, deadline behavior, and notification delivery.

The business scenarios and automated suite confirm the central result: a genuine eligible reply becomes visible follow-up work, while standard chatter history remains intact and known non-actionable traffic stays outside the activity queue.

SECTION Support Information

Technical name: `mail_customer_reply_activity`

License: LGPL-3

Support contact: full.stack.odoo@gmail.com

For a failed acceptance case, provide the scenario number, rule values, target record, sender, subject, whether the message reached chatter, resulting activity details, expected result, actual result, and relevant log message. Remove passwords, tokens, and unrelated private content.